

# Salve, Rei!

Camilo Castelo Branco



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# **+SALVE, REI!+**

**POESIA DE**

*Camillo Castello Branco*

**LISBOA**

Typographia A. J. Ferros & Ferros F.ªs

Rua dos Retrozeiros, 41 e 43

**MCMXV**

# SALVE, REI!

Publicações de Frazão de Vasconcellos

1—*No Centenario da Guerra Peninsular*—Dr. Jacintho Luiz do Amaral Frazão e Vasconcellos. Folha solta, 1910.

2—*Auto-biographia de Herculano*—No 1.º centenario do seu nascimento—Com uma nota—Folheto, 1910.

3—*Diccionario nobiliarchico portuguez*—Incompleto.

4—*Cousas de Camillo*—Poesia *Salve, Rei!*, com uma nótula. Folheto, 1911.

5—*Crês tu? Sim ou não?*—Poesia. Folheto, 1912.

6—*Elementos de heraldica*—Com gravuras, no «Jornal da Mulher».

7—*Justiça do Marquez de Pombal*—Folheto, 1915.

8—*Ascendencia materna do Desembargador João de Barros, auctor do «Espelho de Casados»*. Folheto, 1915.

**EM PUBLICAÇÃO:**

*Linhagistas e heraldistas portuguezes.*

*Um revolta no Rio de Janeiro em 1660*—Nota á margem d'uma biographia de Salvador Corrêa de Sá.

**EM PREPARAÇÃO:**

*Centúria de curiosidades historicas.*

*A heraldica nas vinhetas ornamentaes dos livros portuguezes.*

*Tiragem deste opusculo: 50 exemplares*

## ELUCIDAÇÃO

Em 1911, quando fazíamos ainda parte da redacção da *Nação*, reproduzimos naquelle periodico, n.º 15.255, de 13 de Outubro, a poesia +Salve, Rei!+, de Camillo Castello Branco, de que mandámos tirar uma *separata*, de 32 exemplares numerados, sendo 3 em papel Whatman e os restantes em papel de linho nacional.

Estando todos aquelles exemplares distribuidos, e sendo muitos os camillianistas que desejam possuir a poesia +Salve, Rei!+, resolvemos, sem nenhuns intuitos mercantís, que tambem da primeira vez não tivemos, pois que a edição foi destinada unicamente a offertas, fazer a presente reedição daquella pouco conhecida producção do *Maior de Todos*, como justificadamente os seus mais entusiastas admiradores cognominaram o auctor do *Amor de Perdição* e de tantissimas obras que honram a litteratura portugueza.

Eis a razão desta nova *especie* da extensissima bibliographia camilliana.

Novembro de 1915.

Frazão de Vasconcellos

## Nótula da nossa 1.ª edição

A poesia que se segue, dedicada a El-Rei Dom Miguel I, por ocasião do seu casamento, foi impressa originalmente, em janeiro de 1852, em uma folha solta, e reproduzida no diário legitimista *A Nação*, n.º 1834, de 22 de novembro de 1853, em paralelo com uma outra poesia do mesmo Camillo, transcripta do jornal *O Portuense*, de 17 de novembro de 1853, em honra de Dona Maria II, a quando do seu falecimento.

Na sua preciosa *Bibliographia Camilliana*, refere-se o nosso presado amigo Sr. Henrique Marques a esta pouco conhecida produção do notabilissimo e fecundissimo espirito que foi Camillo Castello Branco, dizendo que viu um exemplar da folha solta, na Bibliotheca Pública do Porto, e informando mais que o *Jornal da Manhã*, daquela cidade, a reproduziu no seu n.º 137, de 19 de maio de 1890.

Frazão de Vasconcellos



## **SALVE, REI!**

Cantor d'outr'ora, quando vi sem flores

Os magicos jardins da phantasia,

Minha lyra depuz.

Não mais pedi inspirações terrenas.

Curvei-me ante o altar, sagrei meu estro

Aos canticos da cruz.

E, sem magoa, quebrei prisões da terra,

Mas uma, se então quiz tambem quebral-a,

Não pude... em vão tentei...

Eram saudades a viver d'esp'ranças,

Saudades, que nem Deus manda esquecel-as,

Saudades do meu Rei!

Ficava-me no mundo um nome grande,

Um symbolo d'amor, de luz radiante,

Sob um manto real...

Imagem do que vi na minha infancia,

Sentado no docel, herança augusta

Dos Reis de Portugal

Christão, pedi com fé—senti que a tinha

Prostrado ante o altar, quando eu pedi

Recursos ao meu Deus...  
Recursos, não pr'a mim que nasci servo,  
Recursos para Vós, Rei desterrado  
Sob inhospitos céus!—

Pulsou-me o coração, senti no labio,  
Em vez da oração, soltar-se o hymno  
D'um peito portuguez!  
Ás lagrimas succede essa alegria  
Dos extasis que á mente imprimem vãos  
D'energica altivez!

Rei! no dia em que desceste  
Do Vosso throno real  
Apagou-se a luz da gloria,  
Cerrou-se o livro da historia  
Do Reino de Portugal.  
Surge o anjo do exterminio  
Sobre as trevas infernaes!  
Traz de fogo a fera espada,  
E com mão ensanguentada  
Rasgas as purpuras reaes.

Sobre o solio dos Affonsos  
Ferreo sceptro esmaga a lei:  
Ruge alli o despotismo  
Se não verga ao servilismo  
Quem lhe diz «Tu não és Rei!»  
Não és Rei! és uma affronta  
Feita ao povo portuguez!  
Não és Rei que não herdaste

Este chão que escravisaste  
A quem falso Rei te fez!

Vaga o anjo do exterminio  
Como inspiração do algoz!  
Corações com Vossa imagem,  
Oh meu Rei! são a carnagem  
Do punhal que fere atroz!  
Foram dias de martyrio,  
De terror e maldição!  
Mas o martyr, expirando,  
Esquecia-Vos só quando  
Lhe morria o coração!

Vaga o anjo do exterminio  
Do mosteiro sobre a cruz,  
E roçando a negra aza  
Pela cruz o templo arraza  
E do altar extingue a luz.  
Cospe injurias e sarcasmo  
Sobre a face do ancião,  
Porque orava, é réo, e expulso  
Foge á morte, e cede ao impulso  
De penuria, e pede pão.

Pede o pão que amassa em pranto  
De saudades que crê vem  
D'uma cella que comprára  
Quando o mundo cá deixára  
Com as pompas que elle tem!  
Pede o pão que lhe usurparam

Com tamanho desamor...  
Fraco, ao vêr que chega a morte,  
Morre... e então mostra que é forte  
Perdoando ao matador!

Lá, no campo da carnagem,  
Mutilado um corpo jaz...  
Ficaram-lhe alli seus ossos...  
Pois que foi um d'entre os Vossos  
Real Senhor! não terá paz.  
Nem a paz dos que morreram  
Sem a nodoa da traição  
Nem a paz da sepultura  
Ao fiel que honrado jura  
Morrer sob o seu pendão

Lá se abraça ao corpo exangue  
No abandono da viuvez  
A que alli vive arrastada  
Mendigando, envergonhada,  
Improperios... talvez!  
Pobre, e só, mãe de tres filhos  
Quando a fome a constrangeu,  
Inda assim, um pensamento,  
Uma esperança, um grato alento  
Foi por Vós que o concebeu...

Vaga o anjo do exterminio  
Enverga o manto real;  
D'um diadema a fronte cinge,  
Mas o sangue que lh'o tinge

Brada vingança fatal!  
N'essa fronte ensanguentada  
Escreveu a mão de Deus!...  
Mas também homens puzeram  
Inscrições onde se leram  
Infâmias como tropheus!

Oh Rei de Portugal! Quando a amargura  
D'este povo infeliz, é sem conforto,  
Valemo-nos do céu!  
Pedimos-lhe por Vós, anjo proscripto,  
Pedimos-lhe vigor á doce espr'ança  
Que em vós o céu nos deu!

Vireis, Senhor vireis, que Deus é justo!  
Vireis enxugar lagrimas amargas  
Que se choram por Vós!  
Sereis de todos Pae, não vingativo,  
E nós todos irmãos, e Vós de todos...  
O Rei de todos nós!

Fatidica aureola circumda  
Nas plagas do desterro dolorosas  
Vossa fronte real.  
Sentado sobre as rochas da montanha  
Lá mesmo na solidão d'amargo exílio  
Sois Rei de Portugal!

Deu-vos um anjo a Providencia augusta  
Em galardão á dôr que amargurastes  
Com Santa intrepidez.  
Um dia curvaremos o joelho

Perante Essa que o ceu fadou Rainha  
Do povo portuguez.

Camillo Castello Branco

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